

# Aviation English Jargon Quick Reference

Field-specific terms, contrast pairs, and high-pressure sentence frames

**Audience:** aviation operations managers, airline staff, maintenance coordinators, safety teams, dispatchers, airport operations staff, ground handlers, and aviation-adjacent professionals

**Focus:** An aviation English curriculum for safety culture, operations control, maintenance coordination, irregular operations, ground handling, compliance, passenger escalation, and incident reporting.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

## Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

### Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority

| Term                     | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| safety management system | Working aviation term used in safety culture and stop-work authority; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| hazard                   | Working aviation term used in safety culture and stop-work authority; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| stop work                | Working aviation term used in safety culture and stop-work authority; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| reporting culture        | Working aviation term used in safety culture and stop-work authority; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

### Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination

| Term             | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| dispatch         | Working aviation term used in operations control and dispatch coordination; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| crew legality    | Working aviation term used in operations control and dispatch coordination; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| aircraft routing | Working aviation term used in operations control and dispatch coordination; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| delay code       | Working aviation term used in operations control and dispatch coordination; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

### Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language

| Term                 | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MEL                  | Working aviation term used in maintenance deferrals and mel language; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| logbook              | Working aviation term used in maintenance deferrals and mel language; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| deferred maintenance | Working aviation term used in maintenance deferrals and mel language; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| airworthiness        | Working aviation term used in maintenance deferrals and mel language; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

### Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| IROP            | Working aviation term used in irregular operations and passenger communication; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| reaccommodation | Working aviation term used in irregular operations and passenger communication; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

| Term          | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| misconnect    | Working aviation term used in irregular operations and passenger communication; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| weather delay | Working aviation term used in irregular operations and passenger communication; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

## Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| turnaround      | Working aviation term used in ground handling and turnaround performance; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| ground handling | Working aviation term used in ground handling and turnaround performance; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| load sheet      | Working aviation term used in ground handling and turnaround performance; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| ramp safety     | Working aviation term used in ground handling and turnaround performance; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

## Security and Access Control

| Term        | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| secure area | Working aviation term used in security and access control; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| badge       | Working aviation term used in security and access control; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| escort      | Working aviation term used in security and access control; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| audit       | Working aviation term used in security and access control; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

## Incident Reporting and Investigation

| Term              | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| incident report   | Working aviation term used in incident reporting and investigation; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| damage assessment | Working aviation term used in incident reporting and investigation; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| root cause        | Underlying reason a problem occurred, not merely the visible symptom.                                                                                                              |
| corrective action | Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.                                                                                                                      |

## Regulatory Audits and Readiness

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| audit           | Working aviation term used in regulatory audits and readiness; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| training record | Working aviation term used in regulatory audits and readiness; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

| Term              | Working meaning                                                                             |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| compliance        | Conformance with laws, regulations, standards, policies, contracts, or approved procedures. |
| corrective action | Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.                               |

## Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

| Situation                                        | Useful language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Safety Culture and Stop-Work Authority           | Before we commit, I want to confirm safety management system, hazard, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If safety, inspection, documentation, and operational control override schedule pressure., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.  |
| Operations Control and Dispatch Coordination     | Before we commit, I want to confirm dispatch, crew legality, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If duty limits, passenger impact, aircraft routing, and recovery options need review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.               |
| Maintenance Deferrals and MEL Language           | Before we commit, I want to confirm MEL, logbook, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If mel conditions, logbook entry, placarding, and operational limitations must be confirmed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                   |
| Irregular Operations and Passenger Communication | Before we commit, I want to confirm IROP, reaccommodation, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If rebooking, hotel policy, crew, aircraft, and safety rationale need clear messaging., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                |
| Ground Handling and Turnaround Performance       | Before we commit, I want to confirm turnaround, ground handling, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If fueling, catering, bags, security checks, and safety zones all have minimum requirements., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.    |
| Security and Access Control                      | Before we commit, I want to confirm secure area, badge, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If access rules, escort requirements, identity checks, and audit risk apply., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                             |
| Incident Reporting and Investigation             | Before we commit, I want to confirm incident report, damage assessment, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If damage assessment, reporting, evidence preservation, and accountability are required., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step. |
| Regulatory Audits and Readiness                  | Before we commit, I want to confirm audit, training record, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If records, currency, scope, and corrective action must be documented., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                               |

## High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

## Contrast Pairs

| Do not confuse                                | Useful distinction                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| safety management system vs reporting culture | In safety culture and stop-work authority, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.       |
| dispatch vs delay code                        | In operations control and dispatch coordination, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision. |

| Do not confuse                       | Useful distinction                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MEL vs airworthiness                 | In maintenance deferrals and mel language, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.           |
| IROP vs weather delay                | In irregular operations and passenger communication, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision. |
| turnaround vs ramp safety            | In ground handling and turnaround performance, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.       |
| secure area vs audit                 | In security and access control, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.                      |
| incident report vs corrective action | In incident reporting and investigation, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.             |
| audit vs corrective action           | In regulatory audits and readiness, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.                  |